

Ἴσυλλος ὁ Ἐπιδαύριος

Isyllus of Epidaurus and the Asclepius Inscription

eul_aid: iei

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Δωρική [Doric](#)

Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Isyllus of Epidaurus was a citizen of Epidaurus active in the late 4th century BCE. His life is known from a lengthy inscription he commissioned at the sanctuary of Asclepius, which mentions a Delphic oracle consultation dated to either 331/0 or 327/6 BCE. The inscription reveals him as a local figure of standing who used his influence to shape Epidaurus's religious and political life.

His sole surviving work is a Sacral Law and Hymns inscription from Epidaurus. This extant stone preserves two poetic compositions: a paeon to Asclepius and a hymn to Apollo and Asclepius, framed by prose narratives detailing their context and the sacred law he proposed.

Isyllus is significant as an epigraphic source for Hellenistic Epidaurus, illustrating how local elites used Panhellenic sanctuaries like Delphi to legitimize civic reforms. His hymns are valuable examples of late classical Doric cult poetry, and their content reflects the political use of myth to assert territorial claims in the Peloponnese after the rise of Macedon.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα IG 4.950](#) · [Fragments IG 4.950](#) · 81 passages